

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] Thank you again for taking part in the interview. As we mentioned in our message, we would like to learn more about your views on romantic relationships. We believe that your experience and perspective would be a great contribution to the project. Is it okay if I record this interview before we start? This recording will only be used for transcription, i.e. taking notes.

Speaker 2 [00:00:21] That would be fine.

Speaker 1 [00:00:22] Okay. First of all, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:27] [21-25].

Speaker 1 [00:00:29] Okay. And how long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] [1-5] years and [1-5] months.

Speaker 1 [00:00:41] Okay. Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:41] And I'm wondering if my voice is a little low. I apologize for that.

Speaker 1 [00:00:44] Is my voice low?

Speaker 2 [00:00:46] Mine sounds comfortable, right? Because for a moment. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:50] It cuts out sometimes, but I can get the sentences.

Speaker 2 [00:00:53] Okay, okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:54] Okay. Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:58] No.

Speaker 1 [00:01:02] Who do you live with at home now?

Speaker 2 [00:01:05] My mom and my sister.

Speaker 1 [00:01:10] What is your main source of income? I mean your current job.

Speaker 2 [00:01:14] I am currently unemployed. I have no source of income.

Speaker 1 [00:01:23] How would you like us to address your partner? I mean boyfriend, wife or boyfriend?

Speaker 2 [00:01:32] It makes no difference. But do I have to choose one? Otherwise, okay. Boyfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:01:44] Now I'm going to ask you to tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship actually started.

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:02:38] Okay, how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:47] I think it's good, actually. I mean, I would say good in general.

Speaker 1 [00:02:57] So do you want to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that? Why do you think like that?

Speaker 2 [00:03:02] I mean, our communication with each other is really good. I feel like I can be myself around him, I can be myself, I don't feel the need to hide my character, I feel like he supports me, I want to support him, I feel like he loves me, I love him a lot, so it's a mutual feeling in general. It's like that, so I hope it's of good quality.

Speaker 1 [00:03:36] Okay, can I ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:03:42] I had [1-5] before this relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:03:45] Mm-hmm. So how would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:03:52] Much much better than before.

Speaker 1 [00:03:58] I see. So can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:04:05] I was in a previous relationship with someone who didn't respect me a little bit and who looked down on me a lot. So I was in a relationship that didn't make me feel good, I couldn't really be myself and I was in a relationship with a very narcissistic character. So it was a little bit bad. Now it's like the opposite of that.

Speaker 1 [00:04:34] What makes a relationship high quality, high quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:41] It's like everything is mutual. Like mutual love (sevgi), mutual respect, understanding and meeting our expectations. And being able to really be ourselves around each other, not pretending to be someone else. Like being fully ourselves.

Speaker 1 [00:05:05] Do you want to expand a little bit more on why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:05:11] Sure, let me think about it. I mean, when things are one-sided, like one-sided respect, one-sided love, it seems to me that the person who shows this always wears out more. That's why I think it's much healthier this way. Secondly, in terms of expectations, if one side doesn't show their expectations, if they don't say it, but somehow they secretly want them to be met and if they are not met, it seems to me that that person wears out a lot and I think there will always be a lack in the relationship when these things are not discussed. But when expectations are shared and properly met or tried to be met, it seems to me that both sides feel better and better about themselves. The other one is being yourself, I think that if we cannot show our full personality in the relationship, it means that we are not comfortable with that person. So if I can be myself around that person, it means that that person makes me feel really comfortable, I can feel good around that person. I think that shows that the relationship is of high quality.

Speaker 1 [00:06:23] Then to summarize, you said that there should be a situation of reciprocity and you said that when it is one-sided, it can be corrosive for the other party and that expectations should be clearly expressed by both parties. So, for example, how can we understand reciprocity or one-sidedness in a relationship when we are in the relationship? Can you tell us more about that?

Speaker 2 [00:06:55] Let me think about it. Reciprocity or one-sidedness. I mean, for example, if someone gives a lot of love and respect, like someone always gives more and more, but they don't get it from the other person, it's like it's a little bit unreciprocal. But if I really love that person, if that person feels that I love them and when they tell me that they love me, I can really feel that they love me, the same goes for respect. Then it's like there is a reciprocity. If I give a little bit of myself to meet his expectations, and he gives a little bit of himself to meet my expectations, or at least we try to understand each other, that is, if it's not one-sided, if it's not just me, it's like reciprocity.

Speaker 1 [00:07:54] Well, for example, when you think about these reciprocity and expectancy parts for your own relationship, for example, can you remember the last time you used this adjective for your own relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:08:10] Let me think about it. Just recently, I think I might have used it this week. Shall I explain? Okay. [00:08:00] Okay. My partner was thinking of going abroad for graduate school. This is going to be a bit challenging for our relationship, but he has dreams and goals after all. I didn't want to stand in front of him in any way, I wanted to support him to realize it. In the same way, I'm looking for a job right now and I'm also looking for some jobs outside the city. So, for example, maybe if I go out of the city, if he doesn't go abroad, then I'll be the one who will move away. But for example, he tries to support me in that regard. He is not really against it. He tries to be by my side. He says that if I will be happier that way, we can work it out somehow. In that sense, for example, I felt like we were mutually supporting each other and she supports me and I support her. I think this happened in the last week.

Speaker 1 [00:09:24] We just talked about something about the quality of the relationship. Now what are the most important things in a relationship for you? I would like to ask you that.

Speaker 2 [00:09:34] The most important things. First of all, it's definitely like really loving each other. I think to really love, to be able to show love. So it's not just words. Apart from that, I think respect is also very important. That both sides respect each other, each other's wishes, each other's lifestyle. Respecting these, respecting each other's personality. I also feel like acceptance. I mean, accepting the person as they are, with their bad sides and their good sides. These three things seem important. Honesty too. Four of them.

Speaker 1 [00:10:18] Okay. So what is true love for you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:29] True love is like loving someone for no reason. I mean without a reason. With the good and the bad.

Speaker 1 [00:10:44] Okay, how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:10:51] I mean it seems like love (sevgi) is more important than love (aşk). It seems like love is important at first but then love is more important, it doesn't feel like love (aşk) is very, very important. I mean it (aşk) is important but love (sevgi) is more important. The alarm went off, I'm so sorry. It's like 40 to 60.

Speaker 1 [00:11:17] How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:22] Hmm. Like by the way they behave. Hmm. If when he does something he makes sure that he doesn't hurt me or upset me. I feel like I can tell more from that. It's more like his behavior, rather than his words.

Speaker 1 [00:11:42] Uh-huh. So, let me ask you this now, what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:55] Hmm...Well, sometimes our personality differences can be a bit challenging. I'm a calmer person, I like a little bit more calmness, he's a little bit more of a hard-natured person. Sometimes he can be a bit harsh with people. That's not something I like very much either. I think it's a little bit difficult.

Speaker 1 [00:12:21] Uh-huh. And do you fight with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:12:27] Rarely, I mean, it's more like an argument rather than a fight. But, it doesn't seem to happen very much. Nowadays it's a little bit often but not too often, a little bit.

Speaker 1 [00:12:38] Uh-huh. Then I was going to ask this but you have answered it. Can you tell me how often these fights happen? Rarely again.

Speaker 2 [00:12:45] Exactly, I mean, serious fights are very rare, but there are small arguments from time to time.

Speaker 1 [00:12:53] Uh-huh. So what might these fights be about in general?

Speaker 2 [00:13:00] This is what I was just talking about last time about the hard temperament of him. I mean, not with me, but with other people sometimes when he behaves that way, I feel uncomfortable. It's usually come up because of this.

Speaker 1 [00:13:14] Uh-huh. So how do you solve these fights?

Speaker 2 [00:13:21] I usually explain clearly what I am upset about and why I am upset. We talk about it. Then somehow it seems to be resolved. I mean, it's more like a clarity comes through talking.

Speaker 1 [00:13:38] Uh-huh. So apart from this solution, what are the other ways of maintaining your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:51] I think a little patience. I'm a bit of a difficult character and he's a bit of a difficult character. I mean, it seems to me that we both try to be a little bit patient at the points where it is not resolved. Maybe that makes it a little bit easier.

Speaker 1 [00:14:06] Uh-huh. Now would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:15] Uh-huh.

Speaker 1 [00:14:16] Okay. And would you like to explain a little bit why that is?

Speaker 2 [00:14:21] Why is it good? Because I feel really loved, I feel like the relationship is good for me, I mean I feel like I'm well connected to my partner, I feel like he's, I feel like he's connected to me and I feel like it's a healthy connection, I feel like it's good for both of our lives in general, or my life in particular I guess, and I feel like there's a lot of positives from my point of view, so it's more like good.

Speaker 1 [00:14:53] Uh-huh. So has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:15:01] It has. A little bit, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:15:05] In what way?

Speaker 2 [00:15:07] Hmm. Before this relationship I was a person with a little bit less confidence. Now I feel a little bit more confident. I mean, my belief that I can do things has increased. I had concerns about my own appearance. They have decreased a lot. So I can say

self-confidence in general. My self-love has also increased a little. So my thoughts about myself have become positive.

Speaker 1 [00:15:33] Uh-huh. And your partner? Did he also change during this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:39] I think yes. Yes, I would say there was a softening of temperament in him too. I think he became a more tolerant person.

Speaker 1 [00:15:49] Uh-huh. So is the person you were before the relationship the same person you are now?

Speaker 2 [00:15:59] When you say person, is it the same boyfriend again?

Speaker 1 [00:16:03] The person you were.

Speaker 2 [00:16:05] I mean, I feel like I'm a better version of myself than I was before the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:16:18] Uh-huh. Now is the same for your partner before the relationship and the same person now?

Speaker 2 [00:16:31] Well, compared to the person I knew before because I've known him for a long time actually. I would say he has become a better, more soft person. More tolerant, more loving. So I feel like he has changed a little bit too.

Speaker 1 [00:16:55] Uh-huh. So do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:00] Uh-huh.

Speaker 1 [00:17:01] Can you explain a little bit why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:17:07] I mean, I feel like someone who can support me is always there for me. I mean, when I feel bad, I feel like there is always somewhere I can go when I feel sad. Apart from that, there is always a person who makes me feel understood. There is always someone who supports me. I mean... It's like that. In general, I feel like there is a person who will always be there for me. So I guess that's why I feel safe.

Speaker 1 [00:17:40] Uh-huh. Now. [00:17:40] Uh oh. Now we go to another part. Here I'm going to put some text on the screen and if you can't read it, it doesn't matter. I will read it again anyway. Like this. Like this. Can you see it? We actually have a scale like this.

Speaker 2 [00:18:13] A little..

Speaker 1 [00:18:17] One to nine. My sentence partner usually really listens to me. Here, if this place is not true at all, we say one. But if it is very accurate then we say nine. I am showing it to visualize it in such a scalar form. I will ask some questions like this.

Speaker 2 [00:18:33] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:18:34] We can do it by visualizing one and nine in front of your eyes or I can show it again from here. For example, let's start with the first question.

Speaker 2 [00:18:42] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:18:42] My partner usually really listens to me. One if it's not true at all, nine if it's completely true.

Speaker 2 [00:18:48] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:18:50] Okay. My partner is usually sensitive to my needs. One if not true at all, nine if completely true.

Speaker 2 [00:19:02] I call it an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:19:04] Uh-huh. So now you gave the first question a nine. Can you explain a little bit why you gave it a nine?

Speaker 2 [00:19:14] Hmm. I mean.

Speaker 1 [00:19:15] So my partner usually really listens to me, let me remind you of the question.

Speaker 2 [00:19:20] I mean I've never felt like I'm not being listened, I mean usually when we talk he listens and really listens. If I have a problem, he thinks about it or if I have a problem, I feel that he is listening to me at that moment. I guess that's why I haven't felt that he doesn't listen to me until now.

Speaker 1 [00:19:39] Uh-huh. So why did you say nine and not eight for example?

Speaker 2 [00:19:49] Hmm. I thought about our previous experiences and wondered if I ever felt that I was not listened to. I mean, I guess I didn't, so I just said nine. I mean, I didn't think of such an experience.

Speaker 1 [00:20:01] Okay. Now you said eight because my partner is usually sensitive to my needs. Why did you say eight?

Speaker 2 [00:20:11] I'm sorry, if there is a sound, the alarm goes off once in a while. Why did I say that? I thought about past experiences, again, I mean, there were moments when I felt that he was not fully sensitive or that he did not care much at that moment. But it didn't happen a lot, it happened rarely, so I didn't want to call it a full nine, because it seems to happen a little bit.

Speaker 1 [00:20:39] Okay. So can you give us some concrete examples of when these things happened?

Speaker 2 [00:20:51] Hmm. I can give maybe one that happened recently. Recently, when I was in the car, I don't like loud noises when I'm driving. It's a very small example, but that's because I thought of it recently. Because I get very distracted while driving. My partner was reading something to me. But I mean, he was reading from the phone. He was reading a little bit like imitating someone's speech. And I realized that he was reading it very loudly and I warned him a few times that he was doing it too loudly, but it's something I'm normally sensitive about and shouting is something that really makes me very nervous. And even though I said so, he didn't stop, didn't stop, didn't stop. Finally, when the conversation was over, I think I expressed it in a slightly offensive way. Then he was offended or something, but we finally fixed it. At that moment, for example, it was a day when I was very tired. It was a day when I had a really bad headache. So it was a very sensitive day. And it's a behavior I don't like anyway, to be yelled at like that and told something. And when he didn't stop even though I said it, I felt a little bit like that that day. This comes to my mind recently. Before that, but I remember something like this happening a few times

Speaker 1 [00:22:14] Uh-huh. So now we've moved on to a new question. I hope you don't mind me asking and if this is too sensitive for you to share please feel free to say so. But we would like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2 [00:22:34] Hmm rare I would say rare.

Speaker 1 [00:22:38] Uh-huh. So how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:22:43] Hmm again on a scale of one to nine? Or not?

Speaker 1 [00:22:48] As you like.

Speaker 2 [00:22:50] Okay then I'll go like on a scale of one to nine. Hmm so I would say seven.

Speaker 1 [00:23:01] Uh-huh. So why do you think that, do you want to elaborate a little bit more?

Speaker 2 [00:23:09] Okay. Since we both live with our families, there is still nothing that would allow such physical intimacy, unfortunately, there is no environment. Therefore, we don't have

the opportunity to experience such a thing much. But when we do, I know that I'm satisfied and I feel good. But since we don't have the opportunity, I kind of wanted to say seven.

Speaker 1 [00:23:33] Uh-huh. How satisfied are you with your relationship in general? I would like to show it like this, from completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied. This time from minus ten to plus ten. Right in the middle is zero. Let me show it again like this.

Speaker 2 [00:23:57] Okay. I think I'll say eight because there are sometimes problems. I can't say exactly ten, but I'm happy with eight, I felt like eight, let's say eight.

Speaker 1 [00:24:17] Uh-huh. So can you explain a little bit more about why that is?

Speaker 2 [00:24:26] Sure. I mean, I'm really satisfied in general. It's a relationship that makes me feel good, but we sometimes have problems, I don't know, little arguments or there are sometimes moments when I feel bad or I make him feel bad. But I mean, we solve them somehow, so it doesn't affect my satisfaction much, but I can't say exactly ten, so it's like eight.

Speaker 1 [00:24:58] Uh-huh. So now we are about to finish but I would like to summarize what we have been talking about for the last half an hour. So you mentioned that you are [21-25] years old. You have a [1-5]-year relationship. You live with your mother and sister. You are still unemployed. [Portion Redacted] You talked about feeling supported for a good relationship in general. And you talked about reciprocity. You had a relationship in the past before this one and he was very disrespectful and condescending. So you were not happy with him. But you feel more positive emotions than in your current relationship. Well, you also said that one of the things that makes a relationship quality is reciprocity, and you even said that yes, you mutually support each other in the same way and make sacrifices for each other's work situations or career goals. For you, the most important thing in a relationship is to truly love and to be able to show love. And love for you is loving someone for no reason. But you said that love is not so important, love is more important, like 40/60. You talked more about personality differences in relationship difficulties. You mentioned that your temperament is softer and your partner's is harder. You said that in conflict resolution you explain your own point of upset, but you mentioned that sometimes it is also important to be patient. Compared to the past, you actually said that you were more confident about yourself before and after the relationship, you said about your appearance when you felt more positive things, and in terms of your partner, you mentioned that there was a softening in his/her temperament and that he/she was a softer person than before. In this way, you actually gave full marks for listening, that your partner listened to you. In terms of sensitivity, you mentioned something small about the car. So you mentioned that you gave him 8 points. But in general, we talked about these things, we talked about these things. Is there anything you would like to add or take away here that I misunderstood or misquoted?

Speaker 2 [00:27:55] I mean, I think not right now. I guess not.

Speaker 1 [00:28:02] Okay, thank you very much first of all. For being involved. Before we finish I would like to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. So I'm going to ask you now which of the data sharing options is better for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain any information that can identify you. In this way, you will be de-identifying your interview transcript so that it can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a little more daring, is to share your entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, i.e. anonymized. With this option, there is a slim chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the choices among colleagues as to who they believe you are. Again, I want to emphasize that no sensitive information is shared. Which of these two options do you prefer?

Speaker 2 [00:29:04] Uh, the first option would be better.

Speaker 1 [00:29:09] Uh, and thank you very much again for participating in this study. In order for this study to be successful, we have one last thing that we would like to ask from you, if it's okay with you. Can you suggest two close people in your life as candidates? We will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this work. We will also ask for couples that we do not know or have not interacted with. This way we will be able to reach as diverse a range of participants as possible. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker 2 [00:29:37] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:29:39] Okay. I'm going to ask you two people and we're going to ask them to refer us to other participants.

Speaker 2 [00:29:47] Okay, okay, well, should I text them or the name?

Speaker 1 [00:29:51] Uh we can do it as a message afterwards. Well thank you for participating. I'm stopping the recording now for a second.